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It is the view of the Legal Adviser that Mr. Yoshida's letter is a clear statement of intention to recognise the Nationalist Régime in Formosa as the de jure Government of China.

2. Three questions arise:

(a) the line to take with the press here; instructions have already been given to Mr. Ridsdale by the Secretary of State;

(b) what should be said to the Americans; I attach a draft telegram to Washington; and

(c) what action is to be taken by Sir E. Dening in Tokyo; I attach a draft telegram to Tokyo.

16th January, 1952.

Permanent Under-Secretary

Tels despatched after amendment by S of S.

Reference:
FO 371/96403
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